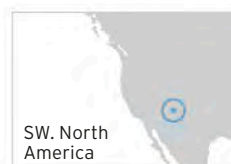


#### PUEBLOAN JEWEL

The large-scale structures at Chaco Canyon were highly organized. The multistory construction and sophisticated masonry used by Ancestral Puebloans illustrate the complexity of their social structure.

# Chaco Canyon

*A remote canyon that holds the huge structures built by the Ancestral Puebloans more than 1,000 years ago*



The Ancestral Puebloans were a Native American people who thrived in the southwestern US from around 750 to 1350 CE. They were great builders, constructing around 125 towns connected by an impressive system of roads. The finest of these towns lie in the Chaco Canyon in a remote area of northwest New Mexico. Most notable are the 15 large, D-shaped complexes—the largest buildings in North America until the late 1800s. These apartment-style structures were made from stone, adobe mud, and other materials, with timber often hauled to the site from up to 70 miles (110 km) away.

#### Pueblo Bonito

The most famous Ancestral Puebloan town, Pueblo Bonito, built around 1050 CE, spreads over more than 110,000 square ft (10,000 square m) and contains at least 650 rooms. It supported a population of more than 1,200 people. Pueblo Bonito and the other towns acted both as ceremonial centers—many of their buildings align with key stages of the solar and lunar cycles—and trading centers for food and luxury goods, such as turquoise.

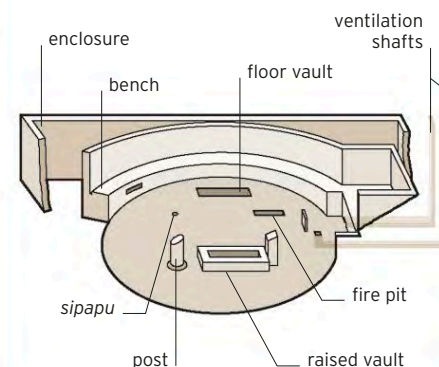


#### △ CHOCOLATE MUGS

It is now believed that the cylindrical jars found in Pueblo Bonito were used for drinking chocolate, made using cacao beans brought from Mexico around 1,200 miles (1,900 km) away.

#### THE KIVA

The *kiva*—a room used for rituals and meetings—attests to the organized society of the ancient Puebloans. Partly underground and roughly circular in shape, it had benches around the edge and a firepit in the center. A *sipapu*, or hole, dug in the north part of the chamber represented the Ancestral Puebloans' place of emergence from the underworld.



**Chocolate** was drunk for the **first time** in North America in Chaco Canyon about **1,000 years ago**